

Research Methodology
Proposal
Measuring Deepfake Detection Literacy in Digital
Content Creators



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Introduction

Deepfake technology is a new and fast-developing trend of digital life. Deepfakes, leveraging artificial intelligence and machine learning, are able to produce extremely realistic but false videos, images or audio that may be very hard to detect as being false. Although this technology may be used in satisfying creative or entertainment needs as well, there exist severe threats of spreading misinformation, online scammers, and damages to reputation, and copyright violations.

Online content creators form a significant element of the online media. They create, disseminate, and popularize the content to a wide audience. In case they cannot recognize deepfake or have an appropriate reaction to deepfakes, they might inadvertently participate in the dissemination of dangerous or fake information. The research paper centers itself around the need to find out how conscious content creators are of the existence of deepfakes, their ability to identify them, and what measures they undertake when they come across this type of content.

Selected Area

Media literacy and cybersecurity in relation to deepfake detection among digital content creators.

It is a study not only of media literacy but also of cybersecurity and closer consideration is given to discovering deepfakes in digital content creation. Media literacy is described as the skills to critically access, analyze, evaluate and create media in an informed manner whilst cybersecurity, is the practice of safeguarding systems, networks and data against digital threats. When applying this research to the topic, these two spheres coincide since the skills that one needs to identify deepfakes involve both the media literacy to analyze images and voices critically and the cybersecurity awareness of how such altered content is produced and used in malicious ways. The study targets content creators, who personally create and post media on YouTube, TikTok, and Instagram, among other platforms thus paying attention to a group of people who significantly define online information, opinion, and digital culture.

Research Problem

Despite the rising popularity of deepfakes, most digital content creators might not understand and be skilled or resourceful enough to notice them and deal with them accordingly. Such ignorance and inability to detect may cause unintentional sharing of manipulated information, which can ruin trust and spread misleading information. Little research has been dedicated to the practical capabilities of content creators to detect deepfakes, as well as how they should react to them, in the framework of daily content creation.

Research Questions

1. What is the current level of awareness among digital content creators about deepfakes and their associated risks?
2. How effectively can digital content creators detect and respond to deepfake content in their work?

Objectives

1. To assess the level of awareness that digital content creators have about deepfakes, including their risks and how they are made.
2. To evaluate the skills of content creators in identifying and verifying deepfakes using signs, fact-checking, and available tools.
3. To analyze the actions taken by content creators when they encounter suspected deepfake content.
4. To suggest practical recommendations for improving deepfake detection literacy through training and platform support.

Aim

Even though their emergence is also increasing, deepfakes can still be relatively new to a broad range of digital content creators who might not have the knowledge or skills or even lack resources that would provide them with a means to detect deepfakes and handle them. Failure to be aware of this and to detect these skills may end up in unwitting sharing of tampered content that will result to loss in credibility and augmented sharing of false facts. Little is known about the practical capability of content creators to detect deepfakes and how to act on it, particularly on a daily basis of contents creation. This research will investigate the depth of deepfake detection literacy in digital content creators by measuring the degrees of deepfake awareness, technical, and practical detection and the response strategies. The research aims not only at comprehending whether the creators can understand deepfakes, but also examines how the ability to do so depends on experience, training, and the selected platforms. The collection of this information will lead to the motivation of the research to make recommendations based on the evidence that may be able to empower creators to develop their skills by strengthening, minimizing the spread of manipulated media, and defending the integrity of the digital content they create and share.

Methodology

Survey - We will distribute a structured questionnaire among a cohort of digital content creators on a variety of platforms (YouTube, TikTok, Instagram) to obtain the information on awareness, detection skills and behavior.

Practical Test- The participants will be presented with a series of selected media which will consist of authentic and manipulated media to determine how they detect such inaccuracies.

Interviews: A small sample of respondents will be interviewed in semi-structured format in order to derive deep-rooted information about their experiences as well as difficulties.

Data Analysis- Survey findings will be analyzed based on the descriptive statistics and interview data analyzed based on themes to determine the pattern, issues, and solutions.